

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The 1948 ban on dual party membership

CONGRESS CONSTITUTION -> amended 1948: BARS DUAL PARTY MEMBERSHIP

TARGET -> Congress Socialist Party (CSP) members inside Congress

FORCED CHOICE -> remain in Congress OR join an independent socialist party

RESULT -> most CSP leaders exit; an INDEPENDENT SOCIALIST PARTY is formed

CONSEQUENCE -> the non-Communist Left's long history OUTSIDE Congress begins

MUST REMEMBER: Congress dominance must be read beside the Socialist exit (1948), Bharatiya Jana Sangh (1951), KMPP-Socialist merger into the PSP (1952), Swatantra Party (1959), CPI split (1964) and the 1967 electoral watershed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The Tandon-Nehru contest, 1950-51

1950 -> CONGRESS PRESIDENTIAL CONTEST: Tandon defeats the Nehru-backed candidate

1950-51 -> friction: Tandon's conservative-Hindu leanings vs Nehru's secular line

1951 -> TANDON RESIGNS the Congress presidency

1951 -> NEHRU HIMSELF then takes over as Congress president

TRAP -> do not reverse this order or compress it into a single year

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Jana Sangh, 1951, is not Swatantra, 1959

BHARATIYA JANA SANGH -> founded 1951, founder SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE

LINK -> organisational links to the RSS network (state this carefully)

PLATFORM -> Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line

SWATANTRA PARTY -> founded 1959, founders RAJAGOPALACHARI / MASANI / RANGA

PLATFORM -> free-market, anti-collectivisation -> a DIFFERENT right-of-Congress line

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: KMPP, 1951, into the Praja Socialist Party, 1952

1951 -> KISAN MAZDOOR PRAJA PARTY (KMPP) founded, led by J.B. KRIPALANI

1952 -> KMPP MERGES WITH THE SOCIALIST PARTY

1952 -> PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY (PSP) formed as a result

AFTER 1952 -> the PSP itself splits and re-forms repeatedly through the 1950s-60s

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The 1964 split in the Communist Party of India

EARLY 1960s -> ideological strain: the Sino-Soviet split

SHARPENED BY -> differing responses to the 1962 border war

1964 -> THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA SPLITS

RESULT -> CPI (one stream) and the new CPI(M)

CONSEQUENCE -> the organised Left enters the mid-1960s divided, not unified

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system'

RAJNI KOTHARI -> political scientist, coins the term "CONGRESS SYSTEM"

CLAIM -> Congress functions as a "PARTY OF CONSENSUS", absorbing factions internally

OPPOSITION ROLE -> parties of "PRESSURE", not alternative-government contenders

ATTRIBUTION -> Kothari's analytical term, NOT a Congress self-description

BOUNDARY -> use only as an analytical lens on the evidence, never as fact-by-itself

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Seat majorities on a minority vote share

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YEAR	CONGRESS SEAT RESULT	CONGRESS NATIONAL VOTE	
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1952	comfortable majority	well under 50 per cent	
1957	comfortable majority	well under 50 per cent	
1962	comfortable majority	well under 50 per cent	
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MECHANISM -> first-past-the-post arithmetic acting on a fragmented opposition

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: The plural, fragmented Indian Left

CPI -> pro-Soviet stream after the 1964 split

CPI(M) -> the new formation after the 1964 split

RSP / FORWARD BLOC -> smaller formations, strongest in Bengal and Kerala

KERALA, 1957 -> the era's clearest Left electoral success (topic 32)

READ IT CORRECTLY -> "the Left" was NEVER a single unified bloc, 1947-67

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Congress as an umbrella, not a narrow party

CONGRESS ORGANISATION -> a broad UMBRELLA

CONTAINS -> Nehruvian planners + conservative traditionalists + regional bosses

MECHANISM -> factional competition happens INSIDE Congress, not mainly between parties

BY THE MID-1960s -> state-level "SYNDICATE" bosses become organisationally decisive

LINK FORWARD -> this factionalism shapes the 1966 succession contest (topic 34)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Lohia's 'non-Congressism': a doctrine ahead of its time

RAM MANOHAR LOHIA -> leading Socialist figure, critic of Congress dominance

DOCTRINE -> "NON-CONGRESSISM": unite the opposition against Congress, despite ideology

1947-67 -> little practical electoral effect

1977 -> the SAME logic underlies the Janata coalition (topic 36)

TRAP -> do not claim non-Congressism succeeded electorally within this topic's period

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system' meant competitive one-party dominance, not a one-party state: first-past-the-post converted sub-50-per-cent vote shares into large seat majorities while opposition parties retained distinct socialist, communist, conservative and regional bases.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: The opposition's ideological range, 1947-67

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PARTY/STREAM	CORE POSITION
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Jana Sangh (1951)	Hindu-nationalist cultural politics
Swatantra (1959)	free-market economic conservatism
PSP and streams	non-Communist socialist politics
CPI / CPI(M)	organised communism, split from 1964
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PROBLEM -> real range, but FRAGMENTED, not unified, before 1967

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Election returns, party constitutions and manifestos, Tandon-Nehru organisational conflict and Kothari's attributed model must replace teleological claims that Congress dominance was either inevitable consensus or disguised dictatorship.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 1967: the watershed this whole topic foreshadows

1948-1964 -> ban, splits, mergers, new parties reshape the opposition

1952 / 1957 / 1962 -> Congress SEAT majority stays large; VOTE SHARE keeps declining

1964 -> CPI splits into CPI/CPI(M)

1967 -> for the FIRST TIME, Congress loses power in EIGHT STATES

READ THE THREAD -> 1967 is the payoff of two decades of party-system change